

Magic Quadrant for Workforce Management (WFM) Technology

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HR leaders seek WFM applications to enhance operational efficiency, ensure compliance and transform frontline workers' experience. Use this Magic Quadrant to gain insights into leading WFM vendors and identify those most suitable to support your frontline workforce deployment.

Strategic Planning Assumption

By 2030, 70% of organizations will adopt AI-enabled workforce management technology to decrease managers' administrative workload by an average of four to six hours per week, optimize operations and enhance employee experience.

Market Definition/Description

Gartner defines workforce management (WFM) technology as a solution comprising software, services and (often) hardware that helps organizations manage their workers' operational deployment. HR technology and operations leaders seek WFM technology to enhance operational efficiency and transform frontline work.

WFM delivers capabilities to manage and optimize the operational deployment of the frontline workforce. This includes aligning staffing with demand, controlling labor costs, ensuring compliance, improving operational decision making and boosting frontline worker engagement and experience.

Mandatory Features

- **Time and attendance (T&A)** — Accurately measuring employee working time and absences, making this information available to payroll and other HR and operational systems. It may include calculating gross pay based on hours worked and pay rate.
- **Absence management** — System to manage planned and unplanned absences, including holiday/vacation and sickness. It may include the calculation of holiday allowance based on accrued working time.
- **Workforce scheduling/rostering** — Providing a means of creating efficient and fair work schedules. May include automated scheduling, scheduling preferences and shift swapping.
- **Reporting and analytics** — Dashboarding, custom reports and analytics to provide business insight into the operational performance of the workforce related to WFM metrics. Examples of insights include the use of overtime, the rate of unplanned absence, and how these differ across sites/employee populations.
- **Compliance** — Delivering tools to help employers manage compliance with legislation and agreements pertaining to working time, pay and leave requirements mandated by government regulations, labor agreements and industry standards.

Optional Features

- **Timeclocks** — Physical devices (hardware) that employees interact with by way of a credential for a minimum of clocking in and clocking out, with some models including touchscreens for further self-service functionality. Various credential types are supported, including card, PIN, fingerprint, finger vein, hand geometry, facial recognition and iris/eye recognition.
- **Mobile self-service** — Full feature parity for use on mobile devices, including phones and tablets, with clients' discretion to select which features are enabled. For example, clients can turn on/off mobile clock-in and clock-out at their discretion.
- **Activity/Task management** — Allocate time against tasks/codes for the purposes of reporting and billing. It also includes the ability to schedule specific tasks or work within a shift.
- **Labor forecasting and demand planning** — Predicts the future volume of employees and forecasts labor demand based on integration with operational systems and historic

scheduling data, seasonality and trend adjustments.

- **Attestation** — Captures electronic confirmation that the employee confirms the data recorded is correct. It is a mandatory requirement in some countries and regions/states.
- **Fatigue management** — Detects the risk of fatigue based on working time and will alert or enforce both the employee and the manager/supervisor that the employee is no longer safe to continue working. The primary use case is in regulated industries, such as nuclear power and transport.
- **Employee listening** — Lightweight employee sensing capabilities designed to capture employee sentiment around shift and working patterns, and help reduce attrition and unplanned absence.
- **Communications** — Provide secure messaging, supporting one-to-one, group and targeted one-to-list communication, and allow for immediate sharing of crucial information via broadcasts, announcements and newsfeeds. Task management is often integrated to facilitate real-time notification and distribution of to-do items.
- **Skills management** — A niche use case for certain industries and countries, but will potentially emerge more broadly. It matches skills prerequisite to employee skills and qualifications during scheduling.
- **Workforce planning** — An emerging capability in WFM, where workforce scheduling focuses on the short-term time frame (weeks/months), workforce planning provides long-term headcount planning, typically one year or more out. It also models long-term headcount requirements, typically calculating the cost of the headcount plan for budgeting purposes.

Magic Quadrant

Figure 1: Magic Quadrant for Workforce Management (WFM) Technology



Magic Quadrant for Workforce Management (WFM) Technology



Gartner

Vendor Strengths and Cautions

ADP

ADP is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. It is a global HR, payroll and workforce management technology and services firm headquartered in Roseland, New Jersey, U.S. Its evaluated product is ADP WorkForce Suite, which is for large, complex organizations and available as a stand-alone offering or integrated with ADP's HR and payroll platforms, including ADP Lyric HCM, ADP GlobalView and ADP Workforce Now. ADP offers ADP Lyric HCM for large global organizations, ADP Workforce Now for midsize organizations and RUN

Powered by ADP for small organizations. ADP WorkForce Suite has approximately 2,000 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 140 countries. ADP WorkForce Suite originated from the acquisition of WorkForce Software by ADP in 2024. ADP partners with multiple AI vendors for advanced AI capabilities.

Strengths

- **Sales strategy:** ADP uses multiple sales teams and channels, including a dedicated WFM sales team for large clients and a reselling partnership with SAP. This enables it to upsell ADP WorkForce Suite as a stand-alone solution or alongside a broad portfolio of human capital management (HCM) and payroll products.
- **Marketing strategy:** ADP delivers tailored marketing content to specific personas and industries. It also actively targets large existing payroll and HCM clients with high proportions of frontline workers.
- **Payroll integration:** ADP is the world's largest payroll services vendor, offering both local domestic and global products. ADP WorkForce Suite is natively integrated with multiple ADP payroll products, which reduces the cost of implementation and maintenance.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** ADP's WFM offerings lag behind the leading edge of innovation, as seen in the lack of agentic AI shift fulfillment capabilities. Most of its AI capabilities focus on AI-enabled robotic process automation (RPA) rather than advanced generative AI (GenAI) or agentic AI.
- **Product strategy:** ADP operates a complex product portfolio that positions WorkForce Suite as a complement to the vendor's payroll and HCM solutions as well as a stand-alone offering. This range of overlapping options can create adoption hurdles for end users seeking to determine the right solution for their organization.
- **Product migration:** ADP plans to migrate legacy UKG-based customers from ADP Enterprise eTIME to ADP WorkForce Suite by 2030. Such a large-scale migration involving thousands of enterprise clients comes with possible risk to service quality and timelines.

ATOSS

ATOSS is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a WFM technology firm headquartered in Munich, Germany. Its evaluated product is ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite for large, complex

organizations. ATOSS also offers Time Control and Crewmeister for smaller, lower-complexity organizations. ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite has approximately 700 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 40 countries. Its WFM offerings originated with the company's founding in 1987 and have been available on the market for 39 years. ATOSS has developed agentic AI capabilities in-house using Microsoft Azure and the Azure OpenAI Service.

ATOSS did not respond to requests for supplemental information. Gartner's analysis is therefore based on other credible sources.

Strengths

- **Marketing execution:** ATOSS is a prolific publisher of digital content. Through this content and its long industry tenure, the vendor has achieved wide brand recognition in its home markets.
- **Geographic expertise:** ATOSS is highly experienced in delivering WFM to the Germany, Austria and Switzerland (DACH) market. This expertise, including how to work with workers' councils, is essential for meeting local regulatory requirements.
- **WFM specialization:** ATOSS is entirely focused on developing and selling WFM products. This allows the vendor to prioritize WFM features for future investment above other product considerations.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite AI investments are primarily focused on deterministic algorithms. ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite currently lacks the more advanced capabilities associated with an enhanced user experience such as agentic AI and natural language interfaces.
- **Market positioning:** While ATOSS emphasizes innovation in its positioning for ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite and has committed to delivering AI agents in a future release, ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite lags behind leading competitors in the development of more advanced AI capabilities.
- **On-premises deployment:** More than half of ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite customers are deployed on-premises — a significantly higher percentage relative to many peer vendors. While ATOSS Staff Efficiency Suite cloud deployments are growing, the existing large on-premises installed base currently reduces potential cloud- and AI-derived revenue.

Blue Yonder

Blue Yonder is a Visionary in this Magic Quadrant. It is a supply chain solutions provider, headquartered in Scottsdale, Arizona, U.S. Its evaluated product is Blue Yonder Workforce Management. It has approximately 1,500 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for 15 countries. Blue Yonder Workforce Management originated from JDA Software's acquisition of RedPrairie in 2012, followed by JDA Software's rebranding to Blue Yonder in 2020. Blue Yonder partners with Microsoft Foundry for AI research and development and with NVIDIA NeMo Agent Toolkit and NVIDIA Nemotron for advanced performance and reasoning.

Strengths

- **Market understanding:** Blue Yonder exhibits thought leadership and originality in market vision. Central to this vision are employee experience and the integration of multiple business systems delivering effective AI-enabled intraday management.
- **Product:** BlueYonder delivers robust product capabilities, especially for AI-enabled WFM processes such as predicting attrition to inform future scheduling and labor demand requirements. It also provides deep functional support for task management, reporting and analytics.
- **Industry specialization:** Blue Yonder sells WFM alongside its broader supply chain management software. This focus offers operational advantages for customers in the retail, logistics and warehouse sectors.

Cautions

- **Marketing execution:** While Blue Yonder publishes digital content, its broader marketing activities are relatively limited. Since the transition from JDA Software to Blue Yonder, this vendor has experienced lower market awareness and visibility.
- **Track record:** Blue Yonder was subject to a ransomware attack in November 2024, which disrupted major enterprise customers. While it was transparent about the incident, this highlights historical security vulnerabilities.
- **Total addressable market:** Blue Yonder's specialization in supply chain without a similar focus in other areas limits the vendor's appeal to organizations in other verticals. To maximize the potential addressable market, Blue Yonder will need to develop capabilities

incorporating the requirements of at least one more major industry in the market, such as manufacturing.

Dayforce

Dayforce is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is an HCM software provider that expanded from payroll services and is headquartered in Minneapolis, Minnesota, U.S. Its evaluated product is Dayforce, which includes WFM modules as part of a broader HCM suite. It has more than 1,000 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 50 countries. Its product originated from Ceridian's 2012 acquisition of Dayforce, followed by Ceridian rebranding to Dayforce in 2024 and its acquisition by Thoma Bravo in February 2026. Dayforce has developed AI capabilities natively and uses development and platform partners including Microsoft Azure, DataRobot, FairNow, EY, UC Berkeley, Harvard, MIT and Vector Institute.

Strengths

- **Sales execution:** Dayforce uses multiple sales channels to achieve strong traction in the market. Also, a recent change in pricing to annual (PEPY) and more incentives for longer initial and interim terms will support stable revenue streams and enable customers committing to longer terms to gain greater leverage and buying power.
- **Product:** Dayforce delivers robust WFM functionality. It provides notable functional depth for advanced scheduling, task management, reporting and analytics, and AI-enabled WFM processes.
- **HCM integration:** Dayforce sells its WFM products as part of an integrated HCM suite that includes payroll and talent management functions. The single-platform architecture aligns daily workforce operations with core HR processes, such as payroll, which enables faster and more accurate payroll processing because payroll and prepayroll data are on the same underlying database.

Cautions

- **Marketing execution:** Dayforce publishes a relatively low volume of digital content pieces. Consequently, while the vendor sponsors and exhibits at major industry events, its brand recognition in the WFM market is lower than some competitors.
- **Geographic strategy:** Compared with other global vendors, Dayforce maintains a smaller geographical footprint. It has fewer data centers worldwide, less localization coverage and

fewer in-country sales teams.

- **Ownership:** Dayforce's February 2026 acquisition by Thoma Bravo will introduce uncertainty for long-term WFM buyers. It remains unclear how the new ownership will balance specialized R&D investments against Dayforce's higher-margin core payroll and HCM business lines.

Infor

Infor is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is an enterprise resource planning (ERP) software vendor, headquartered in Atlanta, Georgia, U.S. Its evaluated product is Infor Workforce Management, which is sold as a stand-alone offering as well as alongside Infor HCM. Infor has approximately 500 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 30 countries. The product has been available on the market for 26 years and became part of Infor through its acquisition of Workbrain in 2007. Infor partners with Amazon Web Services (AWS) for AI, while Amazon Bedrock powers its GenAI and agentic AI capabilities.

Strengths

- **Market understanding:** Infor demonstrates a deep understanding of market trends and customer requirements. The vendor emphasizes intelligent workforce orchestration through the use of AI, compliance and global operations.
- **Industry focus:** While Infor WFM is actively deployed across a range of industries, the product is also specifically configured to meet the requirements of the manufacturing and healthcare sectors. Additionally, Infor WFM has a reputation for being able to support organizations with more than 100,000 employees and complex time and attendance requirements.
- **ERP integration:** Infor sells WFM as part of an integrated suite that combines ERP and HCM, including payroll and talent management functions. This integrated architecture supports both workforce operations and HR processes.

Cautions

- **Financial performance:** Historically, Infor has struggled with limited business momentum in the WFM market as well as across its wider ERP business. This reduced market traction has in turn limited its potential investment in product development.

- **Marketing execution:** Infor publishes a relatively low volume of multimedia marketing content and has reduced its participation in major global events. Despite a long market presence and large customer base, brand recognition is relatively low.
- **On-premises deployments:** While Infor has migrated many on-premises customers to cloud, more than 20% of its customers remain on-premises. For a firm headquartered in the U.S., which is a market with a high affinity for cloud software, this will inhibit growth through lower cloud and AI revenue traction.

Kelio

Kelio is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is an HR, WFM and access control technology firm, headquartered in Cholet, France. Its evaluated product is Kelio. The vendor also delivers other HR capabilities such as an applicant tracking system (ATS) sold as Kelio ATS. Kelio has approximately 2,000 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 30 countries. Its product has been available on the market for 11 years, originating under Bodet Software before the company rebranded to Kelio in 2022. Kelio currently has no named AI or technology partners, as its product is entirely hosted and developed in-house.

Strengths

- **Market understanding:** Kelio demonstrates a deep understanding of market trends and user requirements. It addresses these needs by prioritizing collaborative planning, data visualization and compliance capabilities in its product development.
- **Sales execution:** Kelio has achieved high sales traction in a narrow geographic area through a direct, regional sales team. Additionally, Kelio's ability to offer multiple product options strengthens its commercial appeal.
- **Product strategy:** Kelio has a large existing installed base of WFM customers and also goes to market with wider HR technology and physical access control products, providing the vendor good scope for cross- and upsell.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** Kelio has yet to develop advanced AI capabilities. Its current features are limited to standard rule-based process automation, which has been available in the market for more than a decade.

- **Geographic and industry strategy:** Kelio has limited industry specialization, which restricts its ability to serve larger and more complex clients. Additionally, Kelio's primary focus on Europe also limits its appeal to organizations with global operations.
- **Marketing execution:** Kelio maintains a relatively low market profile with limited marketing execution compared with other providers in this research. Consequently, brand awareness is primarily concentrated among French-headquartered firms, limiting its global visibility.

Legion Technologies

Legion Technologies is a Visionary in this Magic Quadrant. It is a WFM technology firm, headquartered in Redwood City, California, U.S. Its evaluated product is Legion WFM. Legion has an estimated 100 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has localized its WFM solutions for more than 25 countries. Legion WFM was launched in 2016, coinciding with the founding of Legion Technologies. Legion partners with AWS for its technology platform and some AI capabilities. It also partners with OpenAI on foundation models for data handling.

Strengths

- **Market understanding:** Legion was one of the first vendors in the market to incorporate advanced AI into a WFM product. This demonstrates deep understanding and a clear vision of technology trends and the future direction of this market.
- **Innovation:** Legion delivers leading-edge innovation in the WFM market. An example of this is its Deep Labor Analysis Agent, which autonomously ranks store risks and describes underlying causes so that the area manager or executive can apply corrective action.
- **WFM specialization:** Legion is entirely focused on developing and selling WFM products. This approach ensures that the vendor places greater emphasis on WFM feature development when allocating future resources.

Cautions

- **Geographic strategy:** As one of the newer entrants in the market, Legion has limited geographic localization, with the current focus on expansion into North America and Europe. Global organizations should evaluate its ability to uniformly serve their needs in every country.
- **Operations:** Legion operates like a startup, with a lean team and a learn-as-it-grows approach. As its customer base expands, Legion will need more established business

operations to consistently meet customer expectations at a larger scale.

- **Viability:** Legion is the smallest vendor in this research in terms of customer count and employee size. Its scale and product strength may make it an attractive target for acquisition, potentially leading to changes in future strategic direction.

Oracle

Oracle is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is an ERP software and IT solutions vendor, headquartered in Austin, Texas, U.S. Its evaluated product is Oracle Workforce Management, which is a module within Oracle Fusion Cloud HCM and not sold as a stand-alone offering. It has more than 300 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for over 160 countries. Its product originated from native development, with healthcare capabilities augmented following Oracle's 2022 acquisition of Cerner. Oracle develops and hosts its AI capabilities within Oracle Fusion Cloud Applications, which are supported by Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) GenAI.

Strengths

- **Sales execution:** Oracle uses dedicated industry specialist sales teams that are designed to support large, complex clients. It also includes embedded AI with a basic large language model (LLM) at no extra cost and a premium LLM through Fusion AI credits.
- **Industry focus:** While Oracle Workforce Management has been actively deployed in a range of industries, the scheduling capability was initially configured to meet the requirements of the healthcare sector.
- **HCM integration:** Oracle sells WFM within an integrated HCM suite including Workforce Operations Command Center, enterprise integration, payroll and talent management. This simplifies workforce and HR processes.

Cautions

- **Business model:** Oracle only sells WFM capabilities as part of its broader HCM product. While Absence and Time and Labor have been available since 2011, the vendor was relatively late to market with support for advanced workforce scheduling requirements. As a result, adoption has been limited.
- **Marketing execution:** Oracle publishes limited WFM digital content and its presence as a WFM vendor is still emerging despite wider brand recognition. This affects overall brand

awareness and may deter a prospect from considering Oracle for WFM despite its relatively robust product.

- **Customer experience:** Oracle users report below-average satisfaction with the speed and quality of responses from its customer support. For enhanced service, customers may need to evaluate premium Oracle support options.

plano solutions

plano solutions is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a WFM and access control technology firm, headquartered in Ilmenau, Germany. Its evaluated product is plano Roster. It has approximately 300 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for seven countries. Its product has been available on the market for 13 years, originating from native development before the company was acquired by Allegion in 2023. The company continues to go to market as plano. plano currently has no named AI or technology partners, as the product is entirely hosted and developed in-house.

Strengths

- **Market understanding:** plano demonstrates a deep understanding of end-user requirements such as cost optimization, compliance, real-time planning and employee experience transformation. This approach supports customers' key operational and strategic objectives.
- **Marketing strategy:** plano presents the product as a German AI-enabled WFM product. This positioning is supported by the vendor's reputation, product capabilities and the local demand for AI capabilities.
- **WFM specialization:** plano is entirely focused on developing and selling WFM products. This positions WFM features as the primary target for the vendor's future investment, above other product options.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** plano's WFM is currently limited to AI-enabled RPA, with more advanced GenAI capabilities on the roadmap. Additionally, there have been no announcements regarding agentic AI features.
- **Geographic strategy:** plano primarily serves the DACH markets, which limits its global footprint. The vendor is targeting broader expansion into Europe via a partnership with a

reseller, but its current offerings remain highly centralized in its home market.

- **On-premises customers:** More than half of plano's WFM customers are deployed on-premises. This will constrain potential profitability by limiting growth in cloud and AI revenue, which in turn limits total funding available for investment in new features.

Protime

Protime is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. Protime is a WFM technology firm, headquartered in Mechelen, Belgium. Its evaluated product is Protime. It has approximately 150 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for 19 countries. Its product has been available on the market for more than 31 years, originating under Protime before the company became owned by SD Worx, which now positions the product as the workforce management capability within its portfolio. Protime partners with Claude by Anthropic and ML6 for AI capabilities.

Strengths

- **Sales strategy:** Protime has a sophisticated sales structure, with teams organized by country and account size, one regional team for multinational organizations and a reseller channel via parent SD Worx. This approach delivers one of the highest annual new customer acquisition rates among vendors in this research.
- **Market understanding:** Protime prioritizes compliance and labor optimization through the integration of time and scheduling data. This focus aligns with key operational needs for workforce management.
- **Payroll integration:** SD Worx is one of Europe's largest payroll services vendors and delivers prebuilt integration with Protime. The vendor also benefits from joint advertising and sponsorship opportunities through its parent company.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** While Protime has developed a natural language reporting feature, the remainder of its AI capabilities are based on AI-enabled RPA. More advanced AI features are in relatively early stages of development.
- **Industry strategy:** Protime has limited features for high-complexity industries such as healthcare. This lack of specialist functionality for certain large industries restricts its ability to address a broader portion of the market.

- **Product:** Prottime is designed for smaller customers and lower levels of complexity when compared with other vendors in this research. There is little indication that this focus will shift in the near term.

Quinyx

Quinyx is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is a WFM technology firm, headquartered in Stockholm, Sweden. Its evaluated product is Quinyx for large, complex organizations. It has approximately 200 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 30 countries. Its product has been available on the market for 20 years, having originated with the vendor's founding in 2005. Quinyx partners with Claude by Anthropic, Google Gemini and Amazon Bedrock for technology and AI capabilities.

Strengths

- **Marketing execution:** Quinyx has cultivated strong brand awareness as a market disruptor. Notably, it is one of the most searched for vendors on Gartner.com, reflecting its significant market presence.
- **Market understanding:** Quinyx focuses on demonstrating the value of AI in WFM, as well as the priorities of compliance and integration for end users. This focus and vision align with evolving workforce management needs.
- **WFM specialization:** Quinyx is entirely focused on developing and selling WFM products. Consequently, the vendor can direct investment toward WFM features ahead of other product enhancements.

Cautions

- **Geographic strategy:** While Quinyx operates as a global WFM vendor, solution delivery and support outside Europe and North America are limited when compared with larger vendors. Additionally, its North American business represents only a minor portion of the vendor's total customer base.
- **Innovation:** Quinyx has developed AI capabilities, including machine learning for scheduling. However, some WFM processes, such as absence management, still rely on standard RPA rather than modern, GenAI frameworks.
- **Partnerships and alliances:** Approximately 15% of Quinyx deployments are through third parties, which is low for a vendor focused on large, complex organizations. Limited

partnerships and alliances will result in potential scarcity of implementation and support services from third parties, and may constrain potential growth for the vendor.

SAP

SAP is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is a global business applications and IT solutions vendor, headquartered in Walldorf, Germany. Its evaluated products are SAP SuccessFactors Employee Central Time Management, SAP SuccessFactors Time Tracking and SAP SuccessFactors Workforce Scheduling, all sold as part of the SAP SuccessFactors HCM portfolio. SAP WFM products are available exclusively as modules within the suite and require SAP SuccessFactors Employee Central as a prerequisite. SAP has an estimated 300 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 100 countries. SAP's AI capabilities are powered by Joule, built on the SAP Business AI Platform, with Claude by Anthropic serving as the primary reasoning and AI agent.

Strengths

- **Sales execution:** SAP leverages regional sales teams alongside partners to address more complex and niche customer requirements. This approach supports scalability and growth across diverse markets.
- **Marketing strategy:** SAP positions the WFM product as an enabler for the autonomous enterprise, sold alongside the SAP ERP and HCM product lines. In 2026, the vendor is specifically focused on net-new and midmarket opportunities.
- **HCM integration:** SAP offers WFM as part of an integrated suite of HCM, including payroll and talent management functions. The unified platform enhances efficiency across workforce operations and HR functions such as payroll.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** Joule delivers AI and GenAI WFM capabilities, such as speech command and navigation, but much of the underlying WFM processes and configuration remain RPA-based. This limits the extent of advanced AI functionality within the product.
- **Customer experience:** Despite the availability of Joule, SAP customers report below-average satisfaction with the WFM product's user experience. This points to an underutilization of Joule and represents a potential limiting factor for perceived value.

- **Partnerships and alliances:** SAP partners with a number of WFM vendors, including ADP, and has also briefly partnered with UKG. The development of more robust native WFM capabilities by SAP creates uncertainty regarding the long-term future of its partnerships with other WFM vendors, which may affect customers relying on these integrations.

SISQUAL WFM

SISQUAL WFM is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. It is a WFM technology firm, headquartered in Porto, Portugal. Its evaluated product is SISQUAL WFM. It has approximately 130 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 40 countries. Its product has been available on the market for more than 23 years, originating with the vendor. SISQUAL WFM partners with Claude by Anthropic, OpenAI and Microsoft Azure OpenAI for AI capabilities.

Strengths

- **Market understanding:** SISQUAL WFM demonstrates a strong understanding of regional workforce requirements by developing capabilities designed to support employee retention during European labor shortages. This focus aligns with current WFM challenges in the region.
- **Sales execution:** SISQUAL WFM takes a highly flexible commercial position by offering enterprise contracts with no minimum term requirements. This contract flexibility eliminates multiyear lock-ins, placing the commercial priority on the vendor to deliver immediate, ongoing operational value.
- **Dedicated WFM vendor:** SISQUAL WFM is entirely focused on developing and selling WFM products. This strategy enables the vendor to allocate resources to WFM features before considering other product developments.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** While SISQUAL WFM supports AI capabilities, these are not prominently featured in marketing collateral or demonstrations unless specifically requested. The vendor's leadership has taken the position that AI is not one of the chief priorities for buyers at present.
- **Viability:** SISQUAL WFM has achieved scale in terms of customers and users, but revenue generated from this business remains modest compared with peers. This smaller financial

scale may restrict the vendor's long-term capacity for proactive product R&D and increase its operational vulnerability to severe macroeconomic shocks.

- **Business model:** Approximately one-third of SISQUAL WFM's customers are deployed on-premises. This may limit the vendor's ability to maximize growth and profitability and potentially reduce product-related investments compared with larger competitors.

UKG

UKG is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is an HCM solutions firm, dual-headquartered in Lowell, Massachusetts and Weston, Florida, U.S. Its evaluated product is UKG Pro Workforce Management for large, complex organizations. UKG also offers UKG Ready for smaller organizations. It has approximately 4,000 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 35 countries. Its product originated under Kronos with the 2018 launch of Kronos Workforce Dimensions, prior to its merger with Ultimate Software in 2020 to form UKG. UKG partners with Google Gemini for AI capabilities and leverages Google as a technology platform and for hosting services.

Strengths

- **Sales strategy:** UKG has a multilayered strategy in keeping with its complex WFM product portfolio. It includes migrating legacy clients to UKG Pro WFM, upselling UKG Pro customers to the UKG Pro WFM module, and forming industry and regional sales teams and sales alliances with consulting and implementation partners.
- **Industry focus:** UKG WFM is actively deployed across a range of industries, and the product is configured to meet the requirements of the retail, public, manufacturing and healthcare sectors. This enables it to serve industry-specific needs with tailored offerings.
- **HCM integration:** UKG provides WFM as a stand-alone offering or as part of an integrated HCM suite that includes payroll and talent management functions. Consolidating these systems improves both workforce management and HR activities such as payroll.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** UKG delivers AI capabilities, but compliance is handled via a deterministic AI rule engine and RPA. This approach represents a basic automation framework compared with modern, cognitive optimization models.

- **Customer experience:** Customers report below-average satisfaction with the fatigue management function of UKG Pro WFM. Additionally, clients express dissatisfaction with the ongoing account relationship, pointing to friction during contract renewal cycles.
- **Viability:** While the UKG WFM business and broader UKG HR are substantial, overall growth has slowed compared with major competitors. This slower momentum may restrict the vendor's long-term resource capacity for proactive investments in product development and customer service.

Workday

Workday is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. It is an ERP software solution vendor, headquartered in Pleasanton, California, U.S. Its evaluated products are Workday Time Tracking, Workday Absence Management, Workday Scheduling and Workday Labor Optimization, which are sold with Workday Human Capital Management. Workday does not sell its WFM products as stand-alone offerings, but only as modules of the Workday HCM suite. It has approximately 1,600 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 100 countries. Its WFM products originated from native development and have been generally available since 2020. Workday has a variety of partners for AI, including Adobe, AWS, Auditoria, Compa, Glean, Google Cloud, IBM, Kainos, Microsoft and WorkboardAI.

Strengths

- **Marketing execution:** Workday produces a high volume of digital content and is a widely recognized brand in the HR technology space. The vendor actively educates customers about improvements to Workday WFM capabilities.
- **Industry focus:** Workday WFM is deployed in a range of industries. The product has also been configured to meet the requirements of the retail sector, supporting specific operational needs.
- **Integration with HCM:** Workday offers WFM as part of an integrated HCM suite, including payroll and talent management. This cohesive system streamlines workforce operations and HR processes, with payroll being a key beneficiary.

Cautions

- **Geographic strategy:** Workday WFM is a global product, but with the exception of the Time Tracking module, it has not been widely deployed outside the U.S. Global projects

may have limited template availability and require additional testing.

- **Product:** Scheduling has a relatively low adoption rate, and task management is a major area of product weakness, requiring retail and manufacturing clients to engage third-party solutions or accept limited functionality. Workday WFM is also not designed for use in acute healthcare settings.
- **Customer experience:** Workday WFM customers report lower satisfaction with the WFM product compared with other vendors. Features including attestation and labor forecasting receive below-average ratings.

Zebra Technologies

Zebra Technologies is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is a solution provider specializing in digitizing and automating workflows, headquartered in Lincolnshire, Illinois, U.S. Its evaluated product is Zebra Workcloud. It has approximately 130 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for more than 60 countries. Its product has been available on the market for 19 years, originating with Reflexis Systems prior to its acquisition by Zebra in 2020 for \$575 million. Zebra partners with Google Gemini and Strategy One for AI capabilities and Google for hosting services, while it develops its forecasting models in-house.

Strengths

- **Sales execution:** Zebra is currently offering AI features at no additional cost, although this may change as more advanced AI capabilities are added. This approach supports initial adoption and competitive positioning relative to other vendors in this research that charge extra for advanced AI functionality.
- **Product specialization:** Zebra sells WFM as part of a broader portfolio of digital products and solutions including mobile computers, kiosks, scanners and tablets. This portfolio provides operational advantages in sectors where employees interact with multiple devices as part of WFM processes.
- **Industry focus:** Zebra WFM is deployed across various industries, but the product has also been configured to meet the requirements of the retail sector, specifically for task management. This specialization supports tailored solutions for retail operations.

Cautions

- **Innovation:** Zebra offers natural language interaction, but this is currently limited to the task management feature. Conversational analytics are delivered by Workcloud BI Auto Assistant. Its other WFM processes do not yet support natural language capabilities.
- **Partnerships:** Only 10% of implementations are completed by third-party vendors. This model may restrict overall scaling capacity due to resource bottlenecks during peak deployment periods.
- **Viability:** While Zebra is a \$5 billion business, the WFM product represents a small portion of its overall revenue. Combined with the WFM business's origins as an acquisition, this means that the WFM product is at risk of future lower investment focus compared with competitors that generate a greater proportion of their revenue from the WFM market.

Zucchetti

Zucchetti is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. It is an ERP software solution vendor, headquartered in Lodi, Italy. Its evaluated products are the ZScheduling and ZTimesheet modules, alongside AWMS for complex manufacturing clients. It has approximately 400 WFM customers with more than 1,000 employees and has been localized for six countries. Its products have been available on the market for 15 years, with AWMS originating from Zucchetti's 2025 acquisition of AzzurroDigitale. Zucchetti currently has no named AI or technology partners, as the product is entirely hosted and developed in-house.

Strengths

- **Market understanding:** Zucchetti demonstrates a clear understanding of local customer requirements by prioritizing labor optimization and a commitment to focus on customer service levels. Additionally, AWMS delivers robust functionality for manufacturing clients.
- **Industry focus:** While Zucchetti WFM is deployed across a range of industries, the product has also been specifically configured to meet the requirements of the manufacturing sector. This specialization supports operational needs unique to manufacturing environments.
- **HCM integration:** Zucchetti offers WFM as part of an integrated HCM suite that includes payroll and talent management functions. The combined architecture facilitates integrated workforce management and HR workflows, particularly in payroll.

Cautions

- **Geographic strategy:** Zucchetti is primarily focused on serving the Italian market, with localization offered for five neighboring countries. While this approach leverages Italy's complex HR compliance and legislation, it limits broader international expansion opportunities.
- **Innovation:** Zucchetti supports only limited AI capabilities, mainly in forecasting, scheduling and data retrieval. There is currently no provision for GenAI or agentic AI capabilities.
- **On-premises customers:** More than half of Zucchetti's WFM customers are deployed on-premises. This will limit the vendor's profitability through reduced growth in cloud and AI revenue, constraining the funding available for investment in new features.

Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

The inclusion criteria are the specific attributes that a provider must have to be included in this Magic Quadrant. In addition to Gartner client relevance, as determined by analyst expertise and opinion, providers need to meet the following criteria to qualify for inclusion:

- Offer WFM product(s) that is/are generally available by 1 January 2025, either stand-alone or as part of a wider offering (e.g., HCM suite). The product must include mandatory features of WFM technology as defined by Gartner. It must also be deployable as a cloud application with the infrastructure provided by the vendor or a vendor partner.
- Demonstrated sales execution:
 - The vendor must have a minimum of 100 live WFM customers as of 31 December 2025 with more than 1,000 users (employees/workers) or a minimum of 1 million users if below 100 live clients.
 - The vendor must have added 10 net-new customer logos with more than 1,000 users (not including the sale of additional modules or the expansion of existing customers into new sites, and these customers do not need to be live) in calendar year 2025.
- The WFM product or modules must be localized and have live clients in at least two of the following countries: the U.S., Canada, Brazil, the U.K., France, Italy, Germany, India, Australia, China and Japan.

- Vendors must be relevant to Gartner clients, as indicated by Gartner.com searches, inquiry volume and frequency of mention in Gartner Peer Insights and by competitors, Google Trends search index and vendor website traffic analysis.
- Vendors must sell WFM products that were originally developed and are maintained by their own organization. This research does not include resellers of WFM technology. However, it does permit WFM products that have been acquired.

Evaluation Criteria

Ability to Execute

Gartner evaluates a vendor's Ability to Execute by assessing how effectively its solutions support the operational deployment, compliance and engagement demands of shift-based frontline workforces.

Product or Service and Market Responsiveness/Record are weighted highly because WFM deployments represent core operational infrastructure with extremely long lifespans, typically remaining in place for decades.

A high weighting for Product or Service ensures vendors deliver the deep, mandatory capabilities, such as time and attendance, absence management and complex rostering. This is necessary to control labor costs and improve operational decision making.

Market Responsiveness/Record is weighted highly to evaluate how agilely a vendor responds to shifting statutory compliance regulations while delivering secure, transparent and stable systems for clients.

Sales Execution/Pricing, Overall Viability and Customer Experience receive medium weightings to evaluate the ongoing commercial and relational health of the partnership. These criteria focus on contract flexibility, the vendor's ability to deliver value during cross-selling, low customer attrition rates and the presence of reliable, high-quality technical support to navigate complex global or regional configurations.

Overall Viability is prioritized to verify that providers have the financial health, scale and growth to support and invest in their product portfolio over the long term.

Marketing Execution and Operations are assigned low weightings because buyers prioritize immediate software utility, regulatory compliance and system reliability over general brand presence, tradeshow visibility or a vendor’s internal organizational structures.

All seven standard Ability to Execute criteria are utilized in this evaluation. No criteria have been omitted or rated as “Not Rated” in the table.

Ability to Execute Evaluation Criteria	
<i>Evaluation Criteria</i>	<i>Weighting</i>
Product or Service	High
Overall Viability	Medium
Sales Execution/Pricing	Medium
Market Responsiveness/Record	High
Marketing Execution	Low
Customer Experience	Medium
Operations	Low

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Completeness of Vision

Gartner evaluates a vendor’s Completeness of Vision by assessing how effectively it maps out a strategic roadmap, understands frontline market trends and delivers localized, industry-specific WFM solutions.

Vertical/Industry Strategy and Geographic Strategy are weighted highly because to succeed in this market, vendors must meet the unique needs of different industries and countries. The

vendors that can are generally the largest and most successful in the market.

Vertical/Industry Strategy is highly prioritized to evaluate how effectively vendors deliver preconfigured templates, compliance tools and dedicated services tailored to specialized sectors like retail, manufacturing or healthcare.

Geographic Strategy focuses on how effectively a vendor tailors localized software, compliance frameworks and local language templates across major regional WFM markets.

Market Understanding, Marketing Strategy, Sales Strategy, Offering (Product) Strategy and Innovation receive medium weightings to evaluate ongoing commercial alignment and expansion.

A medium weighting on Market Understanding ensures vendors can translate the complex, shift-based operational requirements of large-scale (more than 1,000 employees) frontline organizations into clear, actionable product capabilities.

In a market where WFM platforms remain in place for decades and there is often no single, clear corporate business owner for WFM, marketing and sales strategies must specifically address these complex, long-term buyer dynamics.

Offering (Product) Strategy assesses the provider's near-term product enhancements and release cadences.

Innovation is weighted medium to focus on AI-enabled WFM processes that deliver immediate, quantifiable business value for schedulers and frontline workers.

Business Model is assigned a low weighting because, while vendors' ability to manage implementation backlogs through direct services or external system integrators is a necessary factor, clients prioritize product depth, vertical capability and regional compliance over vendors' internal delivery structures.

All eight standard Completeness of Vision criteria are utilized in this evaluation. No criteria have been omitted or rated as "Not Rated" in the table.

Completeness of Vision Evaluation Criteria

<i>Evaluation Criteria</i>	<i>Weighting</i>
Market Understanding	Medium
Marketing Strategy	Medium
Sales Strategy	Medium
Offering (Product) Strategy	Medium
Business Model	Low
Vertical/Industry Strategy	High
Innovation	Medium
Geographic Strategy	High

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Quadrant Descriptions

Leaders

Leaders demonstrate a market-defining vision for how WFM technology can help organizations achieve business objectives. Leaders have the ability to work toward that vision through WFM products and adjacent solutions and have demonstrated solid business results in the form of revenue and earnings. They are well-aligned with industry trends in AI, deployment and/or experiences, and are ahead of their peers in integrating these AI capabilities.

In the WFM market, Leaders demonstrate a consistent ability to win deals. Leaders have multiple examples of successful global and/or regional implementations by organizations of different sizes (measured by number of employees) with workforces in multiple regions and

across a wide variety of industries. Leaders are the companies against which other providers in this market measure themselves.

Challengers

Challengers have developed a substantial presence in at least one market and have a growing presence in multiple submarkets. Although they have a broader addressable market than Niche Players, they are unable to execute consistently or equally well in all geographies and across all major industries. Challengers understand the evolving needs of organizations but may not lead customers into new functional areas with a strong functional vision. Challengers tend to have a good technology vision for architecture and related considerations but are not as operationally mature as Leaders.

They have strong customer growth and momentum or large existing customer bases, but not usually both. Challengers are further distinguished from Leaders primarily by their reduced Ability to Execute consistently throughout the full range of WFM functionality for large and complex global enterprises.

Visionaries

Visionaries introduce highly innovative product concepts or delivery models that anticipate emerging market needs and expand the market into new areas. However, they are distinguished from Leaders by their limited execution capability and lack of a broad enterprise track record.

The Visionaries in this Magic Quadrant have robust products that often incorporate leading AI capabilities. Common characteristics include a relatively small existing customer base and the operational nature of a startup company, or a narrow industry focus.

Niche Players

Niche Players offer WFM functionality and focus on a narrow geographic area and/or industry. They may offer complete portfolios for a specific industry or workforce size, but they cannot fully support cross-industry requirements for several WFM functions, such as workforce scheduling and task management. They may offer only limited localizations for WFM. From an execution standpoint, Niche Players may lack the ability to support large enterprise requirements or complex global deployments. Niche Players often lag the broader market in terms of development of more advanced forms of AI-enabled WFM.

Nevertheless, Niche Players can offer the best solutions for organizations whose requirements align with their market focus and capabilities. The price-to-value ratio for these vendors is often attractive. They may win consistently in a certain region or industry but not across multiple regions and industries. This may be due to limitations in execution or maturity.

Context

This Magic Quadrant provides a snapshot of the current WFM technology market. It is designed to help you select WFM technology, but it should not be used as your sole resource. Use the companion [Critical Capabilities for Workforce Management Technology](#) to identify how products compare with specific functional categories and how well they align with your operational use cases.

Your final selection criteria must reflect your organization's unique requirements such as the scale of your shift-based frontline population, geographic deployment footprint and localization needs. Do not, for example, select a Leader or reject a Niche Player solely based on quadrant categorization. Assess any vendor that meets your “must-have” requirements — a vendor in any of the four quadrants could be the best choice to support the operational deployment of your frontline workforce.

Market Vendors

The strengths and cautions for the vendors included in this research are based on differentiating capabilities considered within the vision and execution axes. There are some capabilities, such as “Product” and “Market Understanding,” that are relatively robust for all vendors in this market, and so do not commonly appear as cautions.

Market Overview

Market Outlook

WFM technology is characterized by a relatively long lifespan, with deployments regularly being in place for decades. AI-enabled WFM technology can significantly reduce the administrative burden of managers while optimizing operations and employee experience.

Consequently, these capabilities will drive a major investment cycle over the next five years based on two disruptive forces.

AI Maturity in WFM Processes

AI technology that improves the accuracy and efficiency of WFM processes continues to advance. As organizations introduce AI in other aspects of work, such as supply chain tracking, order fulfillment and patient information systems, attention will naturally turn to the use of AI for scheduling and managing time recording for frontline workers.

Partnership Changes Among Major Vendors

UKG and ADP are two of the largest vendors in the market for WFM technology. A longstanding partnership between these vendors is changing, and this change will affect thousands of customers. From 30 September 2026, ADP will cease net-new sales of ADP Workforce Manager (a UKG-derived product) and instead will sell ADP-native products.

Existing clients of ADP Enterprise eTIME will be migrated to ADP-native products by 2030. These existing clients have a major decision:

- Stay with their vendor and migrate to a different product
- Evaluate an entirely different vendor and product

This combination of rapid AI maturation and upcoming product migration is expected to make the next four years a highly active period for WFM system reviews, competitive evaluations and replacements. For further information on this topic, see [HR Technology Trends for 2026](#).

Current Landscape

Demand for ROI Over AI Hype

AI is a differentiator in the market, but a distinct gap has emerged between vendor marketing and real-world adoption. Buyers are moving past future roadmap hype to demand live, production-ready AI capabilities that deliver immediate operational ROI. Systems are evaluated on proven utility, such as AI-powered demand forecasting, shift worker availability mapping, and conversational virtual assistants and agents that can automate daily administrative tasks to directly reduce the scheduling and timecard burden for managers.

Choice of Point Solution or HCM Suite

The WFM market has transitioned to the cloud, yet buyers still choose between specialized, stand-alone WFM suites and integrated HCM suites:

- Stand-alone suites are favored by complex, unionized or highly regulated organizations that require customizable rule engines.
- HCM suites prioritize frictionless payroll integration, though historically they offered lighter scheduling capabilities.

UKG's recent rebranding of UKG Pro Workforce Management highlights a concerted effort by HCM suite vendors to close these functional gaps to win complex enterprise accounts.

Prioritizing Mobile-First Frontline EX to Combat Attrition

Because hourly frontline workers interact with WFM daily, their mobile app serves as their primary digital connection to their employer. Delivering an exceptional employee experience (EX) is now a mandatory criterion to reduce worker attrition and improve the accurate use of the WFM system (and in doing so, improve prepayroll data quality and scheduling operations). Selection processes prioritize mobile self-service that offers flexible scheduling, such as worker availability preferences, shift swapping and shift bidding delivered through a personalized, consumer-grade package. Seasonal sectors such as retail, hospitality and healthcare lead this adoption to improve operational agility and worker retention.

Global Standardization Versus Localized Compliance

While major WFM vendors offer localized solutions across dozens of countries, executing a unified global deployment remains highly complex. Strict regional statutory differences frequently compel global organizations to abandon single-system consolidation in favor of deploying a hybrid mix of localized regional solutions. Localized compliance challenges include European organizations navigating GDPR and the EU AI Act, or the legal mandate in Brazil requiring physical time clocks to print paper receipts. Cost is an additional factor, with local vendors often providing lower-cost solutions than vendors that offer global products.

This first iteration of this Magic Quadrant replaces the Market Guide for Workforce Management Applications.

Acronym Key and Glossary Terms

Intraday management	Corrective measures to a schedule on the day. For example, an employee has not turned up to work so the manager requests cover from a different employee.
PEPY	Per employee per year

⊕ Evaluation Criteria Definitions

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